

The Cost of Always Being Busy: A Better Question

忙碌的代价：更好的问题

Theme: 健康、运动与生活习惯 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The better question came from a **cook** in the **gym** canteen: who decided that **exercise** with a capital letter is the only **therapeutic** movement? “You **provide** a **gymnasium** and call it health,” she said. “My **generation** walked. The **fish** in the market swim all day and never see a **gym**.” The **sound** of a **band** practising in the corridor came through the wall, and nobody spoke for a moment.

The **illusion** was **structural**: a **massive** building with a **painful** absence. “You **admit** a person with a prescription, and you stop at the door of their week,” she said. “**Recreation, music, a short walk**: these are **instrumental** to the condition, not a **distraction** from it.” A **chicken**, a **hot** dish, and a plate of food were her evidence; the fact was that the club had never asked her.

The **dominant** idea in the room was that **suffering** is **exceptional** and that a **breakdown** is a personal failure. “A **collapse** is a signal from an **organism**,” the physiotherapist said. “A **calf** muscle does not lie.” The **reach** of the programme had to **stretch** past the police, the students, and the staff — or the whole **exercise** was a way of spending money on the already healthy.

The **spiritual** part was harder to write. “Kindness is a **facilitation**, not a luxury,” the doctor said. “**Sympathy** without a timetable is only the **imagination** of help.” A **landscape** of small habits, a **series** of **positive** evenings, and a **touch** of real rest were what they had to **provide**; anything else was **insane**.

The second **series** of questions was about **habitat**: where a body actually lives, not where it is trained. “Always understand the walk to the door,” the **cook** said. “That is the real **event**.” The **effort** of the coming week would be to give the programme a place in the lives of people who might never enter a **gymnasium** at all. Sooner or later a body will play, or it will break; there is no third option. It was **difficult** to say which was more dangerous, the drug or the timetable; to **exert** an influence on either required the same patience.

中文翻译

更好的问题来自体育馆食堂的一位厨师：是谁决定只有大写字母开头的“运动”才算治疗性的活动？“你们提供一座体育馆，然后称之为健康，”她说，“我这一代人是走路的。市场上的鱼整天游，从来没见过健身房。”走廊里一支乐队排练的声音透过墙传过来，有一瞬间没有人说话。

这种错觉是结构性的：一座宏伟的建筑，配着一处痛苦的缺席。“你们接收一个拿着处方的人，然后在他们那一周的门槛前停下，”她说，“消遣、音乐、一段短短的步行：这些对处境本身是有用的，而不是对它的干扰。”一只鸡、一盘热菜和一盘食物就是她的证据；而事实是，俱乐部从来没有问过她。

屋里占主导的想法是：苦难是例外，崩溃是个人的失败。“崩溃是一个有机体发出的信号，”理疗师说，“小腿肌肉不会说谎。”项目所能触及的范围必须伸到警察、学生和职工之外——否则这整套练习就只是把钱花在本来就健康的人身上。

精神层面的部分更难写。“善意是一种促成，不是奢侈品，”医生说，“没有时间表的同情，只是对帮助的想象。”一片由小习惯构成的风景、一连串积极的傍晚，以及一点真正的休息，是他们必须提供的东西；除此之外的任何做法都是荒唐的。

第二串问题关于栖息地：一具身体实际上住在哪里，而不是它在哪里被训练。“永远要理解走到门口那一段路，”厨师说，“那才是真正的事件。”接下来这一周的努力，是要把这套项目放进那些也许永远不会走进体育馆的人的生活里。身体迟早会玩耍，否则它就会断裂；没有第三种选项。很难说哪一个更危险，是药物还是时间表；要对其中任何一个施加影响，都需要同样的耐心。

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Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
provide prə'vaɪd POS: vt	vt. 提供, 供应, 规定, 预备; vi. 作准备, 抚养, 规定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. give what is desired or needed, especially support, food or sustenance; v. determine (what is to happen in...
music 'mju:zɪk POS: n	n. 音乐, 乐曲 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an artistic form of auditory communication incorporating instrumental or vocal tones in a structured and c...
reach ri:tʃ POS: n	n. 伸出, 延伸, 区域, 范围, 流域, 岬; vt. 到达, 达到, 伸出, 延伸, 影响; vi. 达到, 延伸, 伸出手, 传到 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of physically reaching or thrusting out; v. reach a destination, either real or abstract; v. reach a...
difficult 'dɪfɪkəlt POS: a	a. 困难的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not easy; requiring great physical or mental effort to accomplish or comprehend or endure
effort 'efət POS: n	n. 努力, 成就 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. use of physical or mental energy; hard work
event i'vent POS: n	n. 事件, 结果, 事情的进程, 竞赛项目; [计] 事件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that happens at a given place and time; n. a special set of circumstances; n. a phenomenon located...
series 'sɪəri:z POS: n	n. 串联, 序列, 连续, 系列, 丛书, 套, 级数, 组; [计] 系列 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. similar things placed in order or happening one after another; n. a periodical that appears at scheduled ti...
sound saund POS: n	n. 声音, 语音, 吵闹, 声调, 听力范围, 探条, 海峡; a. 健全的, 可靠的, 合理的, 健康的, 彻底的, 资金充实的; adv... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the particular auditory effect produced by a given cause; n. the subjective sensation of hearing something; ...
hot hɒt POS: a	a. 热的, 热心的, 辣的, 热情的, 激动的, 猛烈的, 紧迫的; adv. 热, 紧迫地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. used of physical heat; having a high or higher than desirable temperature or giving off heat or feeling or...
admit əd'mɪt POS: vt	vt. 承认, 接受, 允许进入, 容许; vi. 开向, 容许, 承认 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. declare to be true or admit the existence or reality or truth of; v. allow to enter; grant entry to; v. allo...
fish fɪʃ POS: n	n. 鱼, 鱼肉, 鱼类, 接合板; vt. 钓, 钓鱼, 查出, 用接合板连接; vi. 捕鱼, 钓鱼, 用钩捞取, 摸索寻找 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of various mostly cold-blooded aquatic vertebrates usually having scales and breathing through gills; n...
generation ,dʒenə'reɪʃən POS: n	n. 一代, 一世, 产生; [医] 生殖, 世代 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. group of genetically related organisms constituting a single step in the line of descent; n. the normal tim...
positive 'pɒzɪtɪv POS: a	a. 肯定的, 积极的, 有把握的; [医] 正的, 阳性的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the primary form of an adjective or adverb; denotes a quality without qualification, comparison, or relati...
band bænd POS: n	n. 带子, 队, 乐队; v. 联合, 结合; [计] 频带; 波段; 区 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. instrumentalists not including string players; n. a stripe or stripes of contrasting color; n. an adornment...
touch tʌtʃ POS: n	n. 触觉, 碰, 触, 机灵, 轻触, 格调, 少许, 缺点, 弹力; vt. 接触, 触摸, 触及, 使接触, 达到, 涉及, 影响到, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the event of something coming in contact with the body; n. the faculty by which external objects or forces...
exercise 'eksəsaɪz POS: n	n. 行使, 执行, 运动, 练习, 作业; vt. 运用, 练习, 运动; vi. 练习, 锻炼 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the activity of exerting your muscles in various ways to keep fit; n. systematic training by multiple repet...
cook kʊk POS: n	n. 厨子, 厨师; vt. 烹调, 煮饭, 加热; vi. 在煮着 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who cooks food; n. English navigator who claimed the east coast of Australia for Britain and discov...
chicken 'tʃɪkɪn POS: n	n. 小鸡, 鸡肉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the flesh of a chicken used for food; n. a domestic fowl bred for flesh or eggs; believed to have been deve...
landscape 'lændskeɪp POS: n	n. 风景, 山水, 风景画; vi. 从事景观美化; vt. 美化...景观; [计] 横向 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an expanse of scenery that can be seen in a single view; n. painting depicting an expanse of natural scener...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
stretch 'stretʃ POS: n	n. 伸展, 张开, 连绵, 一段路, 一段时间; a. 可伸缩的, 弹性的; vt. 伸展, 张开, 曲解, 使过度伸展; vi. 伸展, 延... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a large and unbroken expanse or distance; n. a straightaway section of a racetrack; n. exercise designed to...
massive 'mæsɪv POS: a	a. 大而重的, 宽大的, 宏伟的; [医] 大块的, 整块的, 大量的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. imposing in size or bulk or solidity; s. being the same substance throughout; s. imposing in scale or scope...
spiritual 'spɪrɪtʃuəl POS: a	a. 精神上的, 神圣的, 崇高的, 高尚的, 鬼的, 招魂术的; n. 有关教会的事 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a kind of religious song originated by Blacks in the southern United States; s. concerned with or affecting...
provided prə'vaɪdɪd POS: conj	conj. 倘若, 以...为条件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v give something useful or necessary to; v give what is desired or needed, especially support, food or sustena...
dominant 'domɪnənt POS: a	a. 占优势的, 支配的; [医] 优性的, 显性的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (music) the fifth note of the diatonic scale; a. exercising influence or control; a. (of genes) producing th...
imagination ɪ'mædʒɪ'neɪʃən POS: n	n. 想像, 听觉, 想像力; [医] 想像 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the formation of a mental image of something that is not perceived as real and is not present to the sense...
structural 'strʌktʃərəl POS: a	a. 结构的, 建筑的; [医] 结构的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or caused by structure, especially political or economic structure; a. relating to or having or...
painful 'peɪnful POS: a	a. 痛苦的, 困难的, 令人烦恼的; [医] 疼痛的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. causing physical or psychological pain
sympathy 'sɪmpəθi POS: n	n. 同情, 赞同, 怜悯, 慰问, 吊唁; [医] 交感[作用], 同感[作用], 感应, 同情 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an inclination to support or be loyal to or to agree with an opinion; n. sharing the feelings of others (es...
collapse kə'leɪps POS: n	n. 崩溃, 倒塌, 虚脱; vi. 倒塌, 崩溃, 瓦解; vt. 使倒塌, 折叠; [计] 折叠 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an abrupt failure of function or complete physical exhaustion; n. a natural event caused by something sudde...
habitat 'hæbɪtæt POS: n	n. 栖息地, 居留地, 自生地, 聚集处; [医] 习生地, 产地, 生境, 栖所 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the type of environment in which an organism or group normally lives or occurs
gym dʒɪm POS: n	n. +体育馆, 体育训练, 体育课, 体操 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n athletic facility equipped for sports or physical training
organism 'ɔ:ɡənɪzəm POS: n	n. 生物, 有机体, 社会组织; [医] 生物[体], [有]机体 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a living thing that has (or can develop) the ability to act or function independently; n. a system consider...
suffering 'sʌfərɪŋ POS: n	n. 苦难, 受苦 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. misery resulting from affliction; n. feelings of mental or physical pain; s. troubled by pain or loss
exceptional ɪk'sepʃənəl POS: a	a. 例外的, 异常的, 特别的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. deviating widely from a norm of physical or mental ability; used especially of children below normal in in...
breakdown 'breɪkdaʊn POS: n	n. 崩溃, 故障; [化] 事故; 击穿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a mental or physical breakdown; n. a cessation of normal operation; n. an analysis into mutually exclusive c...
illusion ɪ'lju:ʒən POS: n	n. 幻影, 错觉, 幻想; [医] 错觉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an erroneous mental representation; n. something many people believe that is false
exert ɪɡ'zɜ:t POS: vt	vt. 发挥, 运用, 施以影响; [法] 施加, 产生, 行使 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. put to use; v. make a great effort at a mental or physical task
calf kɔ:f POS: n	n. 小牛, 小牛皮, 腓肠; [医] 腓肠 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. young of domestic cattle; n. the muscular back part of the shank; n. fine leather from the skin of a calf; n. ...
instrumental ɪn'stru'məntəl POS: a	a. 仪器的, 器具的, 可作为手段的; [医] 器械的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or designed for or performed on musical instruments
recreation ,rekri'eɪʃən POS: n	n. 娱乐, 消遣, 休息, 再创造; [医] 娱乐, 休养 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n an activity that diverts or amuses or stimulates; n activity that refreshes and recreates; activity that ren...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
distraction dis'trækʃən POS: n	n. 娱乐, 分心的事物, 分心; [医] 注意力分散, 内脱位, 牙弓过宽 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. mental turmoil; n. an obstacle to attention; n. the act of distracting; drawing someone's attention away fro...
insane in'sein POS: a	a. 患精神病的, 极愚蠢的; [医] 神经错乱的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. afflicted with or characteristic of mental derangement
therapeutic ˌθerə'pi:ʊ:tɪk POS: a	a. 治疗的, 有益于健康的; [医] 治疗的; 治疗学的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or involved in therapy
gymnasium dʒɪm'neɪzɪəm POS: n	n. 健身房, 体育馆; [医] 体育馆, 健身室, 运动场 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. athletic facility equipped for sports or physical training
facilitation fə,sɪli'teɪʃən POS: review required	[医] 容易化, 助长, 接通[作用] Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the condition of being made easy (or easier); n. (neurophysiology) phenomenon that occurs when two or more...